

October

29



1923

New moves

A new dance trend called the Charleston, which included high kicks and twisting steps, took the US by storm after it appeared in the musical comedy show *Runnin' Wild* on Broadway in New York City, USA.

Born this day

1971 Ma Huateng, Chinese entrepreneur. His global media and technology business Tencent created the social media platform WeChat, which has more than a billion users.

1904 Champion gymnast

German-American disabled gymnast George Eyser won six medals, including three golds, in just one day at the 1904 Olympics in Missouri, USA. Eyser had lost his left leg after being run over by a train as a child, and had competed in the sporting events with a wooden prosthetic leg.

539 BCE

A vast empire

Cyrus the Great, founder of the Achaemenid Empire, arrived in the city of Babylon (near modern-day Baghdad, Iraq) after conquering the Babylonians. His empire would eventually span more than 5.5 million sq km (2.1 million sq miles).



Also on this day

1847 British mathematician **George Boole** published a new system of using 0s and 1s to make calculations. It is still used to program computers today.

2013 The **Marmaray rail tunnel**, the world's first underwater tunnel between two continents, opened beneath the Bosphorus Strait. The tunnel links Europe and Asia.

